

RUKHMABAI, THE CHILD BRIDE

Rukhmabai was married at the age of eleven. When she was older, she filed a case in court, arguing that she had never consented to the marriage, and that she would rather go to prison than live with her husband and give up her studies. The case was settled out of court. She went on to become one of India's first female doctors.

The good fight

Ammu, like many other educated women at the time, was swept up in the fight for freedom. She helped organize hartals, strikes and demonstrations in Madras (now Chennai) during the Quit India Movement. For her activities, she was arrested and sent to the Presidency Jail in Vellore. She was also a key member of the women's rights movement, and helped found the Women's Indian Association (WIA) in 1917, alongside Annie Besant and Muthulakshmi Reddy. She served a term as president of the Madras wing of the All India Women's Conference (AIWC). Both the AIWC and the WIA worked to combat the many discriminatory practices that Indian women and girls were subjected to. As a member of the Constituent